

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

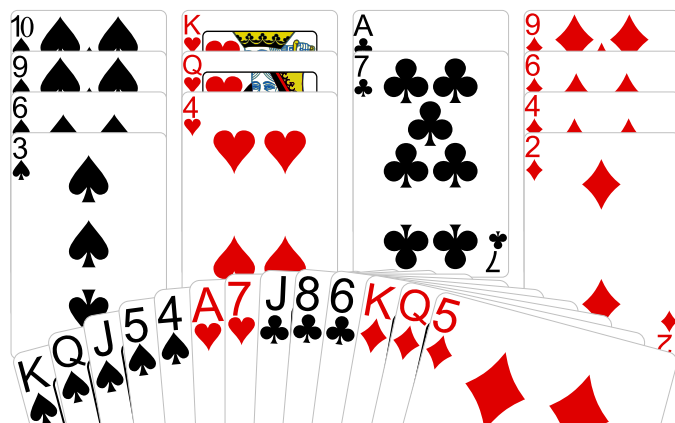
respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

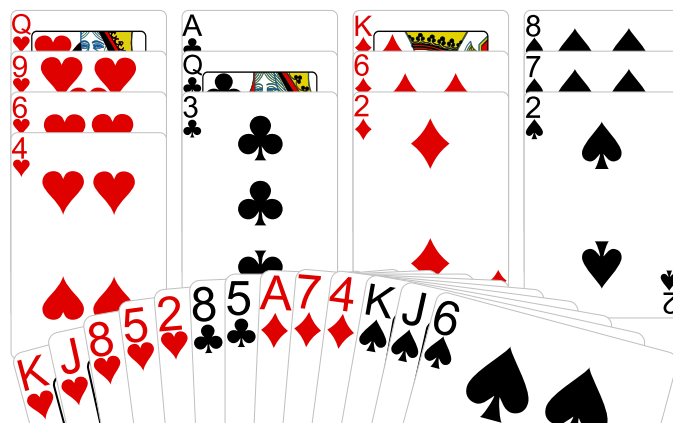
respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



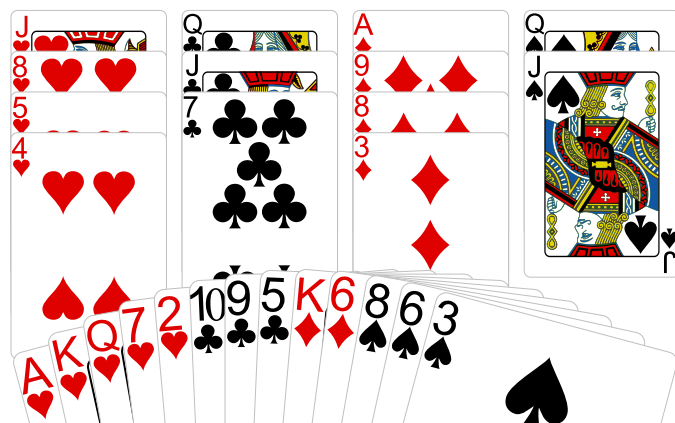
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



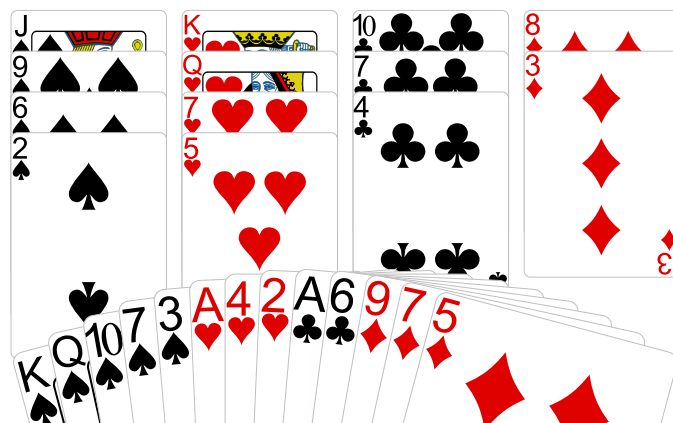
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 2♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3 ♥
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3 ♥
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2 ♠
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: East

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 7
♥ 9 6 5 3 2
♦ A 7 3
♣ K 9 5 2

16
7 8
9

♠ K Q J 5 4
♥ A 7
♦ K Q 5
♣ J 8 6



♠ T 9 6 3
♥ K Q 4
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ A 7

♠ A 8 2
♥ J T 8
♦ J T 8
♣ Q T 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
SOUTH comes through with 4♠.

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NORTH has 17 points and might open 1NT.
But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers

to open 1♠.

SOUTH has good ♠ support and 10 points,
counting 1 for the doubleton ♣.

It is easily worth a raise to 2♠

NORTH cannot bid game yet, after all,
SOUTH could have as few as 6 points. But she
can

continue with a 3♠ bid in hopes that SOUTH
actually has 9 or 10 points.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 8 7 2
♥ Q 9 6 4
♦ K 6 2
♣ A Q 3

8
11 12
9

♠ A Q 5
♥ 3
♦ J T 9 8
♣ J T 9 6 4

N
W E
S

♠ T 9 4 3
♥ A T 7
♦ Q 5 3
♣ K 7 2

♠ K J 6
♥ K J 8 5 2
♦ A 7 4
♣ 8 5

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EAST has a bare minimum 13 point hand, and he should open 1

♥

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WEST has 11 points and good

♥

support so she jumps to 3

♥

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West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

All Pass

3 ♥ by East

EAST knows he has been invited to bid higher, but with nothing above minimum he must pass.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 5 4 2
♥ T 9 6
♦ 5 2
♣ A K 4

11
7 10
12

♠ Q J
♥ J 8 5 4
♦ A 9 8 3
♣ Q J 7



♠ 8 6 3
♥ A K Q 7 2
♦ K 6
♣ T 9 5

♠ A K 9
♥ 3
♦ Q J T 7 4
♣ 8 6 3 2

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			

3♥ by South

A Limit Raise is an invitational bid, but SOUTH can add and he knows the total points will

be either 24 or 25. So he passes 3



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NORTH has 11 points and she should pass.

SOUTH has a minimum 1



opening, 13 points and five trumps.

NORTH, with 4-card trump support, jumps to 3



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(This is called a Limit Raise.)

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q T 7 3
♥ A 4 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6

12
13 6
9

♠ A 8 5
♥ J 3
♦ Q 4 2
♣ K Q 5 3 2

N
W E
S

♠ 4
♥ T 9 8 6
♦ A K J T 6
♣ J 9 8

♠ J 9 6 2
♥ K Q 7 5
♦ 8 3
♣ T 7 4

West

1 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by West

North

Pass

East

2 ♠

South

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WEST has a normal 1 ♠ opening bid, 14 points
and five trumps.

EAST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so
she raises to 2 ♠.

WEST passes, knowing he is not missing a
game contract. EAST can have a maximum of
10 points, which would

only reach 24 points when added to his 14.

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J T 9
♥ A 4 2
♦ T 9 5 4
♣ Q 8 7

15
7 7
11

♠ A Q 7 5 3
♥ K Q
♦ A 8 7 6
♣ 9 4



♠ K 6 4 2
♥ J 8 5
♦ K 3 2
♣ A 6 2

♠ 8
♥ T 9 7 6 3
♦ Q J
♣ K J T 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠		3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

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With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points NORTH should open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand,

he jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

NORTH adds: her 16 plus SOUTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4 ♠.

Deal 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5

6

11 16

7

♠ 9

♥ T 8 2

♦ Q T 9 7 3

♣ A T 8 7



♠ 5 3 2

♥ K Q J 9 5

♦ J 4

♣ 6 4 2

♠ J T 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 3

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

He bids 4 ♠.

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EAST has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT.

He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others

would disagree so for this Deal EAST will open 1 ♠.

WEST has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support.

So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3 ♠.

EAST adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high.